Last-Day Revision Sheet

Essential definitions, models, distinctions and facts, one block per lecture.

Week 1

L1. Introduction to Soft Skills

- Soft skills = umbrella term: personality traits, social graces, language facility, personal habits, friendliness, optimism.
- Hard skills get the job; soft skills make you excel. Communication is only a part of soft skills.
- Key behavioural skills: self-awareness, flexibility, persistence and perseverance.
- Vivekananda: arise (self-aware), awake (self-confident), stop not (dynamic).

L2. Aspects of Soft Skills

- Aspects: communication, attitude, adaptability, teamwork, conflict management, leadership, time/space, mannerism, cultural sensitivity.
- LSRW: listening (60–75% of time), speaking, reading, writing.
- Hats: white objective, red emotion, yellow positive, green ideas, blue control.
- Hume: truth springs from argument amongst friends; teams are the primary performance unit (Bidlake).

L3. Effective Communication Skills

- Process: sender → encode → channel → receiver → decode → feedback.
- Shaw: biggest problem is the illusion that communication has been accomplished.
- Qualities: clarity, completeness, conciseness, correctness, courtesy, candidness (7 Cs).
- Grapevine: informal, rumour-prone; internal flow upward, downward, horizontal, diagonal.

L4. Classification of Communication

- Forms: intrapersonal, interpersonal (dyadic), extra-personal, group, mass/media.
- Oral = spontaneous, immediate feedback; written = organised, record, delayed feedback.
- Libel (written) vs slander (spoken); avoid plagiarism and misquoting.
- 6 lakh+ non-verbal cues; meaning lies with the sender.

L5. Personality Development

- Personality ← *persona* (mask); an inner set of qualities, not looks.
- Id = pleasure; ego = reality (executive); superego = perfection (moral guardian).
- Adler: social interest, fictional finalism, superiority, creative self.
- “The child is the father of the man.”

Week 2

L6. Positive Thinking

- Positive thinking = positive mental attitude (Peale).
- Berne: OK/OK = positive and co-operative; OK/not-OK = imposing; not-OK/not-OK = introvert; not-OK/OK = negative.
- Johari (Luft and Ingham, 1955): open, blind (unknown to self), hidden (unknown to others), unknown (to both).
- Believe in your abilities; concentrate on goals.

L7. Telephonic Communication Skills Part I

- Features: clarity, courtesy, consideration, brevity.
- Make call: own call, agenda, identify self, purpose, polite close.
- Receive call: within three rings, identify self, positive tone, accurate message.
- Avoid negatives ('No', 'You have to'); use 'What can I do for you?'

L8. Telephonic Communication Skills Part II

- Voice mail: substitute for memos/calls; solves time zones; no immediate feedback.
- Teleconferencing: short notice; poor for negotiations; needs facilitator.
- Video conferencing: three types; control body language; look at camera.
- Cell etiquette: low tone, silent in public, no odd-hour calls.

L9. Communicating Without Words

- Birdwhistell 35/65; Mehrabian 7/38/55.
- Types: kinesics, proxemics, chronemics, paralanguage, haptics, meta-communication.
- Kinesics: appearance, face, eyes, posture, movement, gesture.
- Eyes: rapport and credibility; culture-specific.
- Crossed arms/legs negative; open hands welcome.

L10. Paralanguage

- Features: quality, volume, rate, pitch, pronunciation, pauses.
- Rate 140–150 wpm; middle path.
- Faults: throaty, breathy, nasal, harsh, muffled, hoarse.
- Content words stressed; function words not.
- Twain: rightly timed pause; Pythagoras: silence is better than unmeaning words.

Week 3

L11. Proxemics

- Zones: 18 in / 4 ft / 12 ft / 30 ft+.

- Intimate: family; personal: friends; social: strangers; public: speakers.
- Low context: US, Germany, England; high context: Japan, China, Arab.
- Time talks and space speaks (Hall).

L12. Haptics: The Language of Touch

- Haptics = touch (Greek ‘I touch’).
- Handshakes: dominant, submissive, equal, dead fish, glove.
- Thailand: no head touching; Spain: 7 strokes; NZ: hongi.
- Mulk Raj Anand: Untouchable (Bakha).
- When unsure, restrict touch.

L13. Meta-communication

- Meta = beyond.
- Examples: ‘Leave him, not kill him’.
- Silence: neutrality, hiding, disagreement, thinking time.
- Non-words (ah, um) show doubt.
- Rich: lying with silence; Kennedy pause.

L14. Listening Skills

- Hearing = physiological; listening = mental.
- Process: hear, filter, interpret, respond, remember.
- Nathan: perceptive listening, sincere desire.
- Barriers: prejudging, ambiguity, bias, rigidity.
- 60–75% of time in listening.

L15. Types of Listening

- Combative, attentive, reflective (most important).
- Content, empathetic, appreciative, analytical.
- External: noise, venue, time, culture.
- Internal: ego, state of mind, language.
- Take notes; do not interrupt; open mind.

Week 4

L16. Negotiation Skills I

- Negotiation = argument + persuasion → agreement.
- Formal: agenda, date, venue; informal: casual.
- Place, time, atmosphere, fear, influence.
- BATNA best fallback; WATNA worst; ZOPA overlap.
- Aim at win-win.

L17. Negotiation Skills II

- Phases: preparation, interaction, implementation.
- Red, blue, purple (best).
- You-attitude; sunny side.
- Collaborate, accommodate, compromise, control, avoid.
- Get what you negotiate.

L18. Culture as Communication

- Culture = learnt traits, values, behaviour; dynamic.
- Dimensions: context, individualism, formality, style, time.
- US direct; Arabs and Asians relationship first.
- GATT, NAFTA; global village.
- Show deference, not difference.

L19. Communicating across Cultures

- Culture = code learnt and shared.
- Low context: words; high context: silence and relation.
- Avoid ethnocentrism and stereotyping.
- Six stages of ethno-relativism.
- Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam.

L20. Organizational Communication

- Scott: transmission + feedback → action.
- Functions: forecast, organise, instruct, coordinate, control.
- Roles: interpersonal, informational, decisional.
- McGregor: control vs persuasion.
- Use informal channels to supplement formal ones.

Week 5

L21. Communication Breakdown Part I

- Breakdown at source, between people, in organisation.
- Source: background, inference, rigid, frozen, allness.
- People: perception, vocabulary, emotion, listening, selectivity, noise, semantic gap.
- Twain’s lightning bug.

L22. Communication Breakdown Part II

- Barriers: hierarchy, fear, attitude, transfer stations, media, jargon, noise, ethics.
- Remedies: empathy, listening, open climate, fewer levels, feedback.
- Message sent ≠ message received.

L23. Advanced Writing Skills

- Bacon: writing maketh an exact man.
- Conceptualise → research → draft → revise.
- Direct plan: good news; indirect: bad news.
- Nine patterns.
- Short, simple, reader-centred sentences.

L24. Principles of Business Writing

- 5 Cs.
- Express, not impress.
- many, soon, fully, I assume.
- Negative in the middle; positive ending.
- Eliot: no big words.

L25. Types of Business Writing Part I

- Memo: informal, no salutation, designation in From, cc.
- Letter report: 2–3 pages, inside address, close, enclosures.
- Circular: awareness; four types.
- Revise before sending.

Week 6

L26. Types of Business Writing Part II

- Notice → agenda → minutes.
- First/last agenda items.
- Minutes past tense, signed.
- No capitals in e-mail.
- Research paper steps.

L27. Business Letters

- 10 parts.
- Dear Sir/Madam; Yours faithfully/sincerely.
- Body in 3 paragraphs.
- Enclosures with pages.
- Neutral, direct tone.

L28. Business Letters: Format & Style

- Full block, modified block, semi-block, simplified.
- Full block: all left.
- Simplified: no salutation/close.

- You-approach; no blame.
- Follow organisation's practice.

L29. Types of Business Letters Part I

- AIDA.
- Analysis, anticipation, adaptation.
- Good news first; bad news softened.
- Order: specific, payment.
- Refusal retains goodwill.

L30. Types of Business Letters Part II

- Collection: gentle → strong.
- Claim: problem first; no blame; documents.
- Adjustment: good news first; active; empathy; thanks.
- Recommendation: honest, specific.

Week 7

L31. Report Writing

- Reportare = re + portare.
- Formal, factual, systematic, purpose- and audience-specific.
- Objectives: update, evaluate, guide, inform, recommend, awareness.
- Report vs literary table.

L32. Types of Reports

- Five bases of classification.
- Recommend only if asked.
- Informative vs analytical.
- Routine: fixed interval, proforma.
- Special: critical, no format.
- Bathing-suit quote.

L33. Strategies for Report Writing Part I

- Purpose, audience, method, organise, outline.
- TOR.
- Primary vs secondary.
- Observation cannot interpret.
- Phone: reach vs depth.

L34. Strategies for Report Writing Part II

- Interview: cues, control, costly.
- Questionnaire: cheap, anonymous, low response.
- Closed, rating, open, MCQ.
- Tricky in the middle; covering letter.
- Ruskin quote.

L35. Evaluation and Organization of Data

- Probability: random, systematic, stratified.
- Non-probability: convenience, judgment.
- Decimal numbering, max 3 levels.
- Coordination, subordination, parallelism.
- Outline = half the job.

Week 8

L36. Structure of Reports: Part-I

- Front matter, body, back matter.
- Cover → abstract order.
- Preface (author) vs foreword (expert).
- Contents has pages.
- Abstract < summary.

L37. Structure of Reports: Part-II

- Introduction, discussion, conclusion, recommendation.
- Conclusion: no new information.
- Recommend if asked; feasible.
- References cited; bibliography consulted.
- APA vs MLA.

L38. Report Style: Part I

- Simple, specific, familiar.
- Avoid cliché, jargon, redundancy.
- One modifier; no phrasal verbs.
- Explain abbreviations.
- Hawthorne.

L39. Report Style: Part II

- Active vs passive.
- Subject–verb close; emphatic order.

- Split breathless sentences.
- Unity, coherence, order.
- Fog < 12; Orwell's windowpane.

L40. Group Communication

- Group vs team.
- Formal, informal, virtual.
- Groupthink; hidden agenda.
- Cooperation, loyalty, cohesiveness.
- Forming–Adjourning.

Week 9

L41. Leadership Skills

- Autocratic, democratic, laissez-faire.
- Transactional vs transformational.
- Structure vs consideration.
- Fiedler: fixed style.
- Trust: integrity, competence, consistency, loyalty, openness.

L42. Group Discussion: Part I

- GD unstructured, cooperative.
- Debate structured.
- 7–10 members; 15–25 min.
- Topic vs case.
- Driver, amiable, democrat, bulldozer.

L43. Group Discussion: Part II

- Emergent leader.
- Silent member = liability.
- Listen, organise, speak early.
- No chairman role.
- Influence not dominate.

L44. Meeting Management

- Decision is the main function.
- Why, who, when, where, what.
- Start on time; follow agenda.
- Minutes official.
- Deadlines and follow-up.

L45. Adaptability and Work Ethics

- Adaptability = learning.
- Ethics = right and wrong.
- Kant: ends not means.
- Seven rights.
- Avoid plagiarism, pilfering, misquoting.

Week 10

L46. Advanced Speaking Skills

- LSRW – speaking.
- Immediate, emotive, spontaneous.
- Voice, vocabulary, audience, style.
- Familiar words.
- Franklin quote.

L47. Oral Presentations, Speeches, and Debates

- Inform, persuade, entertain.
- Presentation: small group, aids.
- Speech: occasion, no aids.
- Debate: argument, rebuttal.
- Courtesy.

L48. Combating Nervousness

- Natural and universal.
- Energising.
- Prepare; know audience.
- Pause, breathe, slow.
- Record yourself.

L49. Patterns and Methods of Presentation

- 5 Ps.
- Chronological, causal, problem–solution, spatial, topical.
- Manuscript, memorised, impromptu, extemporaneous.
- Be brief in impromptu.
- Outline for extemporaneous.

L50. Oral Presentation: Planning & Preparation

- Purpose, topic, audience.
- Familiar topic + new information.

- Short spoken sentences.
- Intro short; body 2–3 points.
- Conclusion restates.

Week 11

L51. Making Effective Presentations

- Hook start; emphatic end.
- Practise, time, record.
- Moderate rate; eye contact.
- Slides = outline.
- Connectives.

L52. Speeches for Various Occasions

- Six types.
- No visual aids.
- Opening and closing key.
- Tone matches occasion.
- Brief, humble, warm.

L53. Interviews

- Systematic oral process.
- 9 types.
- Confidence + information.
- 7 stages.
- Prepare and start early.

L54. Planning and Preparation: Part-1

- Analyse yourself, identify skills.
- Research organisation and job.
- USP.
- Intuitive vs learned skills.
- Interview file; will to win.

L55. Planning and Preparation: Part II

- Résumé: French; CV: Latin.
- Purpose: interview call.
- Chronological, functional, hybrid.
- 1–1.5 pages.
- Action verbs; no salary.

Week 12

L56. Drafting an Effective Resume

- Résumé = passport.
- Objective: 1–3 lines.
- Education: latest first.
- Cover letter: 3 paragraphs.
- Show, don’t tell.

L57. Facing Job Interviews: Part- I

- Prepare; be patient.
- Let the interviewer lead.
- Personality counts.
- Navy/grey suit; black shoes.
- Clear voice; use pauses.

L58. Facing Job Interviews: Part II

- 7 question types.
- Open at the start.
- Affirmative and ethical answers.
- No salary talk.
- Sit when asked; close door gently.

L59. Emotional Intelligence and Critical Thinking

- EI = recognise + manage emotions.
- IQ gets job, EQ success.
- 5 components.
- Neutrality; non-judgmental.
- Different, not indifferent.

L60. Applied Grammar

- Police/clothes plural; news/politics singular.
- No apostrophe in yours.
- Nearest-subject rule.
- A/an by sound.
- Senior to; since vs for.